Google Interview Guide

Process, Rounds, and Preparation Strategy

1. Interview Rounds

- Coding interviews (2-4): algorithms and data structures.
- Googleyness / leadership round: behavioral.
- Role-specific: system design or domain knowledge.

2. Coding Round Focus

- Strong fundamentals: arrays, strings, hash tables, trees, graphs.
- Dynamic programming and recursion appear frequently.
- Write clean, correct code with edge cases handled.
- Discuss time and space complexity clearly.

3. Problem-Solving Approach

- Restate the problem and ask clarifying questions.
- Start with a brute-force solution, then optimize.
- Test with small examples and edge cases.
- Communicate constantly while coding.

4. Googleyness / Behavioral

- Questions about collaboration, ambiguity, and leadership.
- Use STAR format with measurable impact.
- Show humility, curiosity, and a bias to action.

5. System Design (for senior roles)

- Practice designing scalable systems (search, maps, video).
- Know trade-offs between different approaches.